

THE BIZ

The shift to South Africa has cost franchises some revenue

- The event, according to some estimates, will end up being worth Rs 1,200 crore.
- On-air sponsorships have gone up but team sponsorships have fallen by 15 percent.
- TV ad rates doubled but Sony's new deal means breaking even at Rs 854 crore.

THE OMNIPRESENT IPL
CHEERLEADERS



THE BRAND

The move overseas was a significant moment for the IPL

- Moving to South Africa turned the IPL into a global brand, the biggest in cricket.
- What was missing was the immediacy of the event for Indians and the home and away factor.
- South African cricket's efficiency and infrastructure has raised the bar for the event.

THE IPL WAS VERY WELL
RECEIVED IN SOUTH AFRICA



IN A BATSMEN-FRIENDLY TOURNAMENT,
BOWLERS LIKE R.P. SINGH HAVE SHONE

structure and providing the gloss that a big event should have."

On the surface, the IPL was Cricket Central, with the who's who and the who's he variety crossing paths. Locals came to watch because the cricket was loud, the fireworks were deafening, the music was hot and the dancers were diverting.

Behind the stagedoor, however, there were two cricket cultures trying to reconcile two completely different styles of doing business. A CSA staffer described the IPL entourage in two pithy words: "f***g impossible". A caterer was told that he could get the IPL contract but would only get paid 60 days after the event, and he would just have to absorb expenses of Rs 68 lakh for four months. The IPL had announced low ticket prices to bring in the crowd but when they started to flock in, doubled the rates for the semi-finals and final.

Along with the cricketers came a bunch of precious Indians. A franchise owner snapped his fingers and ordered a chartered plane when only three out of five seats he wanted could be found in business class. His children could not fly economy on a 55-minute flight. Tantrums were thrown

when suites in Johannesburg's Michaelangelo Hotel could not be blocked (for no charge) for another bigwig taking an overnight break to visit Kruger National Park. South Africa may even miss the IPL but some of its Indians will not be missed.

What of the future? IPL 3 will be here in less than a year, the tournament slotted for March 2010. Expect a debate about the cap on foreign players in the playing XI and a series of minority stakes in franchises to be put up for sale.

They are now calling it the IPL a two-billion dollar tournament. At least, a UK-based brand valuation consultancy Brand Finance is. The polite coughing of financial experts offers an explanation. The timely release of this \$2 billion dollar figure, they say, will be used to over-heat the market in minority stakes.

An IPL insider says, "The franchises are looking for a wealthy, irrational investor with discretionary income who doesn't mind parting with a few millions to be seen on TV." What is being sold then is not a financial investment but the chance to mingle with cricketers and rub shoulders with some Bollywood stars. "It's the most expensive entertainment ticket in the world," with *Jhilmil Motihar*